DEVELOPER HANDOFF

Ask Me Loader Experience

Implementation-ready summary for loader phases, states, typography, color, motion, interactions, and accessibility.

1. Dynamic AI phase model

> **Core requirement:** Phases are generated dynamically by the AI from the current request and real execution plan. Do not hard-code phase count, labels, order, or duration.

Property	Required behavior
Phase count	Variable; based on task complexity and tools required.
Labels	Generated from the actual operation in clear user-facing language.
Order	Follows the live execution plan and may adapt when the plan changes.
Timing	No predefined duration. Show elapsed time only.
Completion	Driven by real backend/tool events, never by UI-only timers.
Retry	Insert or update a phase when recovery work actually occurs.

- Only one phase is visually active at a time.
- Completed phases remain available in the expanded view.
- Use present-progressive copy while active and past tense after completion.
- Do not show fake percentages, estimated durations, or simulated progress.
- Render unknown/new phase types with the same reusable phase component.

2. Required states

Pending
Muted icon/text; no animation.

Active
Blue animated glyph, shimmer title, elapsed time.

Complete
Stable checkmark, past-tense copy, no animation.

Retrying
Keep loader active and state that recovery is running.

Failed
Red icon/title, clear reason and next action; stop animation.

Stopped
Stop timers/tasks immediately; show restart or retry.

3. Type styles

UI: Inter · **Technical:** JetBrains Mono

Element	Style	Color
Loader/phase title	14px / 600	Slate 800
Agent heading	14px / 500 / 1.4	Slate 800
Narration	14px / 400 / 1.7	Slate 600
Supporting detail	12px / 400 / 1.5	Slate 500
Timer, values, code	12px / Mono	Slate 600–800
Metadata labels	10px / 500 / Mono	Slate 400

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4. Color tokens

Primary
#1E293B

Secondary
#475569

Tertiary
#64748B

Muted
#94A3B8

Border
#E2E8F0

Surface
#F8FAFC

Active
#2563EB

Error
#B4472B

5. Motion and layout

Item	Specification
Expand/collapse	160–320ms
Content fade	200–240ms
Active pulse	1.6s
Heading shimmer	2.6s
Header	10px gap; 8px top / 6px bottom padding
Phase row	9px gap; 6px vertical padding
Technical card	560px max; 10px radius; 10–14px padding

- Animate only the active phase.
- Stop animation after completion, failure, or cancellation.
- Support `prefers-reduced-motion`.
- Icon sizes: status/phase 16px, loader glyph 18px, composer actions 20px.

6. Interactions

Expand
Entire header is clickable. Add `aria-expanded` and preserve state during updates.

Stop
Visible only while active. Stops timer, transitions, and pending work.

Copy
Copy SQL/JSON only. Show “Copied” feedback for about 2 seconds.

Replay
Reset timer, phase, errors, copy feedback, and collapsed state.

7. Error behavior

Error and retry states are event-driven. The AI may add a recovery phase, rename the active phase, or continue with an alternate plan based on the actual failure.

> **Final failure:** Explain what failed, what recovery was attempted, and the next action available to the user. Do not use a fixed message when the context is known.

Keep raw errors and provider details inside expanded technical details. Never leave an active animation running after a terminal failure.

8. Responsive and accessibility

- Keep typography sizes unchanged on mobile.
- Use minimum 44×44px touch targets.
- Stack input/output cards vertically; allow code overflow scrolling.
- Provide keyboard access and visible focus for expand, stop, retry, replay, and copy.

- Announce phase changes using `aria-live="polite"`; do not announce the timer every second.
- Maintain 4.5:1 text contrast and never communicate status through color alone.

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9. Acceptance checklist

- [ ] One active phase
- [ ] Accurate elapsed timer
- [ ] Past-tense completed copy
- [ ] Collapsed by default
- [ ] Expand works by keyboard
- [ ] Stop affects actual processing
- [ ] Replay fully resets state
- [ ] Copy feedback works
- [ ] Retry is clearly communicated
- [ ] Failure stops animation
- [ ] Reduced motion supported
- [ ] All deployed assets return 200